

DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE & THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY

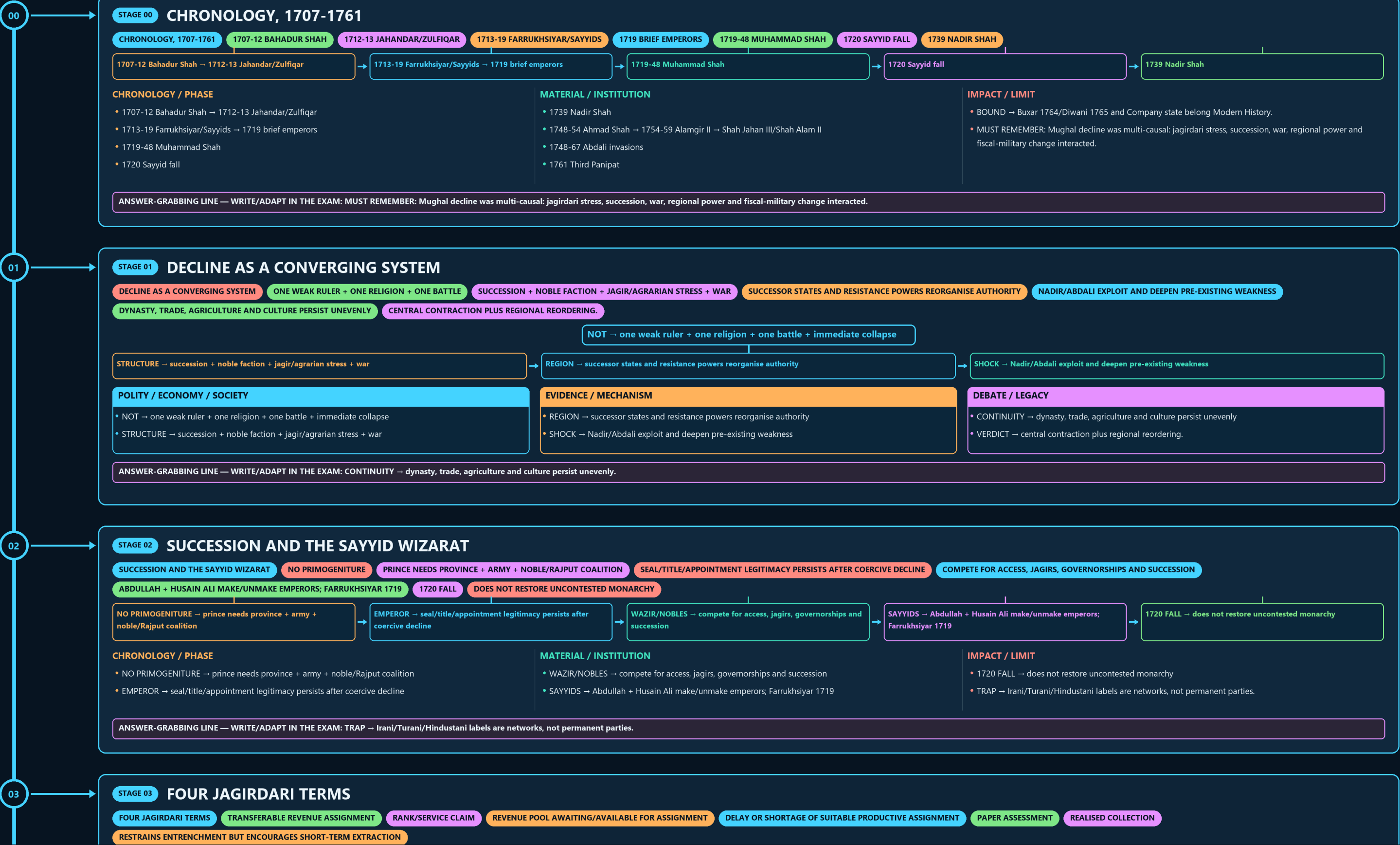
CHRONOLOGY, 1707-1761 → DECLINE AS A CONVERGING → SUCCESSION AND THE SAYYID → FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS → THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP → THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

• EMPEROR → seal/title/appointment legitimacy persists after coercive decline

• SAYYIDS → Abdullah + Husain Ali make/unmake emperors; Farrukhsiyar 1719

• TRAP → Irani/Turani/Hindustani labels are networks, not permanent parties.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → Irani/Turani/Hindustani labels are networks, not permanent parties.

04

STAGE 03

FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS

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TRANSFERABLE REVENUE ASSIGNMENT

RANK/SERVICE CLAIM

REVENUE POOL AWAITING/AVAILABLE FOR ASSIGNMENT

DELAY OR SHORTAGE OF SUITABLE PRODUCTIVE ASSIGNMENT

PAPER ASSESSMENT

REALISED COLLECTION

RESTRAINS ENTRENCHMENT BUT ENCOURAGES SHORT-TERM EXTRACTION

JAGIR → transferable revenue assignment

MANSAB → rank/service claim

JAMA → paper assessment

HASIL → realised collection

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → crisis means malfunction and scarcity, not disappearance of jagirs.

05

STAGE 04

THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP

THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP

MORE CLAIMS

MANSABDARS + DECCANI/MARATHA ENTRANTS + COURT REWARDS

POOR JAGIR

LOW HASIL + DEBT + THIN CONTINGENT

SHORT TENURE ENCOURAGES COERCION/CORRUPTION

LOCAL RESPONSE

ZAMINDAR BARGAIN/RESISTANCE + PEASANT FLIGHT + CHAUTH

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → fiscal + administrative + military + social feedback.

06

STAGE 05

THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN

THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN

ANNEXATION + FORTS + GARRISONS + LONG SUPPLY +

DEFEATED DECCANI/MARATHA ELITES ENTER MUGHAL SERVICE SYSTEM

MARATHA WAR

PARALLEL REVENUE AND MOBILE RESISTANCE REDUCE COLLECTION

AURANGZEB CHOICE

BUFFERS REMOVED AND SETTLEMENTS MISSED

EARLIER MANSAB GROWTH + AGRARIAN/LOCAL POWER + NO PRIMOGENITURE

1687-1707 → annexation + forts + garrisons + long supply + emperor absent north

CLAIMANTS → defeated Deccani/Maratha elites enter Mughal service system

MARATHA WAR → parallel revenue and mobile resistance reduce collection

AURANGZEB CHOICE → buffers removed and settlements missed

INHERIT → earlier mansab growth + agrarian/local power + no primogeniture

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → responsibility matters, but one ruler did not create every structure.

07

STAGE 06

FROM CENTRE TO REGION: A SPECTRUM

FROM CENTRE TO REGION

A SPECTRUM

EMPEROR RETAINS LEGITIMACY AND TITLES

AUTONOMOUS PROVINCE

MUGHAL GOVERNOR CONTROLS REVENUE/ARMY, NOMINAL LOYALTY

SUCCESSOR STATE

DURABLE COURT AND PROVINCIAL FISCAL-MILITARY REGIME

RESISTANCE STATE

CENTRE → emperor retains legitimacy and titles

AUTONOMOUS PROVINCE → Mughal governor controls revenue/army, nominal loyalty

SUCCESSOR STATE → durable court and provincial fiscal-military regime

RESISTANCE STATE → zamindar/community/military base builds new authority

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE & THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2699-5933 of 11332 • continues below

FROM CENTRE TO REGION

A SPECTRUM

EMPEROR RETAINS LEGITIMACY AND TITLES

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MUGHAL GOVERNOR CONTROLS REVENUE/ARMY, NOMINAL LOYALTY

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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• SUCCESSOR STATE → durable court and provincial fiscal-military regime

• RESISTANCE STATE → zamindar/community/military base builds new authority

DEBATE / LEGACY

• TRIBUTE/CHAUTH → influence without uniform direct administration

• RULE → devolution and adaptation, not simple secession or anarchy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → devolution and adaptation, not simple secession or anarchy.

07

STAGE 07

BENGAL, AWADH AND HYDERABAD COMPARED

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MURSHID QULI KHAN; REVENUE CONTROL + COMMERCE + NOMINAL

SAADAT KHAN; ZAMINDAR MANAGEMENT + GANGA MILITARY-FISCAL BASE

NIZAM-UL-MULK; DECCAN BASE AFTER WITHDRAWAL FROM DELHI FACTION

MUGHAL TITLES/OFFICES/ADMINISTRATION AND PERSIANATE COURT

ECOLOGY, REVENUE, MILITARY NETWORK AND COMPANY EXPOSURE

AUTONOMY DID NOT BEGIN WITH MODERN INDEPENDENCE DECLARATIONS.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

BENGAL → Murshid Quli Khan; revenue control + commerce + nominal tribute

AWADH → Saadat Khan; zamindar management + Ganga military-fiscal base

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

HYDERABAD → Nizam-ul-Mulk; Deccan base after withdrawal from Delhi faction

COMMON → Mughal titles/offices/administration and Persianate court

DEBATE / LEGACY

DIFFER → ecology, revenue, military network and company exposure

TRAP → autonomy did not begin with modern independence declarations.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• BENGAL → Murshid Quli Khan; revenue control + commerce + nominal tribute

• AWADH → Saadat Khan; zamindar management + Ganga military-fiscal base

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

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08

STAGE 08

JATS, SIKHS AND MARATHAS: BOUNDED SNAPSHOT

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BOUNDED SNAPSHOT

CHURAMAN/BADAN SINGH/SURAJ MAL; BHARATPUR FORTS + ZAMINDARI/ROUTES

BANDA PHASE

MISLS/DAL KHALSA

AFGHAN SERVICE/MIGRATION NETWORKS ESTABLISH ROHILKHAND POWER

SHAHU + PESHWA + HOLKAR/SCINDIA/GAEKWAD/BHONSLE

CHAUTH/SARDESHMUKHI + MOBILE ARMIES + BARGAINING

JATS → Churaman/Badan Singh/Suraj Mal; Bharatpur forts + zamindari/routes

SIKHS → Banda phase → repression/reorganisation → misls/Dal Khalsa

ROHILLAS → Afghan service/migration networks establish Rohilkhand power

MARATHAS → Shahu + Peshwa + Holkar/Scindia/Gaekwad/Bhonsle

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• JATS → Churaman/Badan Singh/Suraj Mal; Bharatpur forts + zamindari/routes

• SIKHS → Banda phase → repression/reorganisation → misls/Dal Khalsa

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• ROHILLAS → Afghan service/migration networks establish Rohilkhand power

• MARATHAS → Shahu + Peshwa + Holkar/Scindia/Gaekwad/Bhonsle

DEBATE / LEGACY

• INSTRUMENT → chauth/sardeshmukhi + mobile armies + bargaining

• TRAP → no single anti-Mughal bloc or uniform successor empire.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → no single anti-Mughal bloc or uniform successor empire.

09

STAGE 09

NADIR SHAH, ABDALI AND PANIPAT

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1739 KARNAL

MUGHAL COMMAND/FACTION FAILURE

DELHI SACK AND EXTRACTION

DEVASTATING RAID AND EXPOSURE; NOT ORIGINAL CAUSE OR INDIAN

ABDALI 1748-67

REPEATED PUNJAB/NORTH-INDIA INTERVENTIONS

ABDALI COALITION DEFEATS MARATHAS; MUGHAL EMPEROR NOT MAIN BELLIGERENT

1739 KARNAL → Mughal command/faction failure → Delhi sack and extraction

NADIR → devastating raid and exposure; not original cause or Indian annexation

ABDALI 1748-67 → repeated Punjab/north-India interventions

1761 → Abdali coalition defeats Marathas; Mughal emperor not main belligerent

CAUSE → supply + alliances + non-combatants + Rohilla/Abdali coordination

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• 1739 KARNAL → Mughal command/faction failure → Delhi sack and extraction

• NADIR → devastating raid and exposure; not original cause or Indian annexation

• ABDALI 1748-67 → repeated Punjab/north-India interventions

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• 1761 → Abdali coalition defeats Marathas; Mughal emperor not main belligerent

• CAUSE → supply + alliances + non-combatants + Rohilla/Abdali coordination

• LIMIT → Panipat checks northern bid, not Maratha power or British inevitability.

DEBATE / LEGACY

• CLOSE DISTINCTION: Hyderabad, Awadh and Bengal were successor states that adapted Mughal institutions, not mere evidence of anarchy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Hyderabad, Awadh and Bengal were successor states that adapted Mughal institutions, not mere evidence of anarchy.

1739 KARNAL → Mughal command/faction failure → Delhi sack and extraction

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POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 1739 KARNAL → Mughal command/faction failure → Delhi sack and extraction
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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

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10

STAGE 10

REGIONAL ECONOMIC AND CULTURAL CONTINUITY

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AGRICULTURE + TEXTILES + INTERNAL TRADE + CREDIT +

WAR + MULTIPLE LEVIES + ROUTE INSECURITY + INVASION

COMMERCIAL STRENGTH CAN COEXIST WITH WEAK DELHI CENTRE

AWADH/HYDERABAD/RAJASTHAN/PUNJAB/BENGAL/MARATHA COURTS

MOVEMENT CREATES REGIONAL STYLES USING MUGHAL FORMS

POLITICAL FRAGMENTATION IS NOT CIVILISATIONAL DARKNESS.

EVIDENCE LIMIT

CONTINUE → agriculture + textiles + internal trade + credit + urban demand

DISRUPT → war + multiple levies + route insecurity + invasion by region

BENGAL → commercial strength can coexist with weak Delhi centre

PATRONAGE → Awadh/Hyderabad/Rajasthan/Punjab/Bengal/Maratha courts

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CONTINUE → agriculture + textiles + internal trade + credit + urban demand
- DISRUPT → war + multiple levies + route insecurity + invasion by region
- BENGAL → commercial strength can coexist with weak Delhi centre

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- PATRONAGE → Awadh/Hyderabad/Rajasthan/Punjab/Bengal/Maratha courts
- ARTISTS/LITERATI → movement creates regional styles using Mughal forms
- VERDICT → political fragmentation is not civilisational darkness.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: The eighteenth century is a transition with regional growth and new competition, not a teleological prelude to British rule.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EVIDENCE LIMIT: The eighteenth century is a transition with regional growth and new competition, not a teleological prelude to British rule.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The eighteenth century is a transition with regional growth and new competition, not a teleological prelude to British rule.

11

STAGE 11

NON-INEVITABILITY AND FINAL ANSWER SPINE

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1687-1707 BURDEN

1707-39 COURT/REGION

1739-61 MULTIPOLARITY

JAGIR FEEDBACK + SUCCESSION/WIZARAT + LOCAL/REGIONAL POWER

NADIR/ABDALI REVEAL AND DEEPEN WEAKNESS

ECONOMY/CULTURE AND MUGHAL LEGITIMACY CONTINUE UNEVENLY

SARKAR + CHANDRA + AGRARIAN + REGIONAL SYNTHESIS

PERIODISE → 1687-1707 burden → 1707-39 court/region → 1739-61 multipolarity

EXPLAIN → jagir feedback + succession/wizarat + local/regional power

SHOCK → Nadir/Abdali reveal and deepen weakness

QUALIFY → economy/culture and Mughal legitimacy continue unevenly

HISTORIOGRAPHY → Sarkar + Chandra + agrarian + regional synthesis

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PERIODISE → 1687-1707 burden → 1707-39 court/region → 1739-61 multipolarity
- EXPLAIN → jagir feedback + succession/wizarat + local/regional power
- SHOCK → Nadir/Abdali reveal and deepen weakness

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- QUALIFY → economy/culture and Mughal legitimacy continue unevenly
- HISTORIOGRAPHY → Sarkar + Chandra + agrarian + regional synthesis
- PYQ → zero direct Topic-25 routes, 2018-2026; Mains has no key

DEBATE / LEGACY

- BRIDGE → fragmentation permits Company gains; Modern History explains them.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HISTORIOGRAPHY → Sarkar + Chandra + agrarian + regional synthesis.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED EVIDENCE NOTEBOOK

TWENTY-FOUR SOURCE-TO-ARGUMENT LABS

EVIDENCE AND ANSWER-WRITING DRILLS

DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE & THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Advanced evidence notebook: twenty-four source-to-argument labs
- Evidence and answer-writing drills
- Decline of the Mughal Empire & the Eighteenth Century — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles
- + Historiography ladder (PYQ-gap)

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.